COMPANY OPERATING SYSTEM

Deployment Checklist

Pre-deployment

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Tool versions, limits and vendor prices change. Always verify against official documentation and pricing calculators before building or quoting.

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Use for **every** staging and production deployment. The DevOps engineer executes; the Technical Lead gives go/no-go; the PM informs the client. Keep the completed checklist as deployment evidence.

Project		Version / tag		Environment	
Date / window		Executed by		Approved by	

A. Pre-deployment (T minus 1 day)

Item	Done
Client approved the change plan and the maintenance window (UAT signed for production)	☐
Release candidate tagged; CHANGELOG and release notes complete	☐
CI green on the exact commit; the same image digest was tested in staging	☐
Infrastructure matches the approved IaC/plan (no manual drift)	☐
Secrets present in the secret store for this environment; none in the repository	☐
Database migrations reviewed; backward compatible; rollback or forward-fix plan written	☐
Fresh backup taken and restore verified	☐
Monitoring, alerts, on-call contacts and cost/budget alerts active	☐
Rollback plan tested in staging; previous image tag retained	☐
DNS plan ready; TTL lowered to 300 s at least 24 h before cut-over (if DNS changes)	☐
Admin ports closed; database private; least-privilege IAM confirmed	☐
Communication sent to client and team (time, expected impact, contact)	☐

B. Deployment

Step	Time	Done
Announce start in the team channel; open the deployment log		☐
Enable maintenance mode if needed		☐
Run the pipeline/promotion with approval; apply migrations		☐
Verify the running version and configuration		☐
Smoke tests: home, login, key journey, API `/health`, payment sandbox/live-safe check		☐
Disable maintenance mode		☐

C. Post-deployment (first 60 minutes)

Item	Done
Logs show no error spike; p95 latency and 5xx rate within normal range	☐
Monitoring shows green; uptime check passing	☐
First production backup completed	☐
HTTPS valid (padlock, chain, HSTS as planned); HTTP redirects to HTTPS; no mixed content	☐
DNS records verified from two public resolvers; e-mail send/receive tested	☐
Search engines: production indexable, staging blocked; sitemap submitted	☐
Analytics and error tracking receiving events	☐
Client smoke check and confirmation received	☐

D. Evidence record

Field	Value
Deployed version / image digest	
Start / end time	
Approver (name)	
Test results (link)	
Issues encountered and actions	
Rollback executed? (Y/N, reason)	

ROLL BACK IMMEDIATELY IF

Login or payment fails; error rate is clearly above baseline; data corruption is suspected; the smoke tests fail and the cause is not found within the agreed 15 minutes. Then report to the TL and PM and write a post-incident review.